

Taking Charge of ADHD: Psychologist's Implementation Summary

Dr. Russell Barkley's 8 Golden Rules Translated for Home Life | Framework: Barkley Executive Function & Self-Regulation Theory

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Clinical Resource Packet

CHILD'S NAME	AGE / GRADE	DATE	COMPLETED BY

Barkley's Core Executive Principles for Parents

BARKLEY PRINCIPLE	CLINICAL TRANSLATION INTO DAILY HOME PRACTICE
1. Time Blindness	Children with ADHD live in the "Now" vs. "Not Now". Never say "in 10 minutes". Use a visual timer where disappearing colored disk represents passing time.
2. Externalize Working Memory	Internal mental lists fail under distraction. Put checklists physically at the point of performance (bathroom mirror, entryway, study desk).
3. Externalize Motivation	Long-term goals ("do well in term exams") do not trigger dopamine. Provide immediate, micro-rewards for initiating and completing single work segments.
4. The 30% Developmental Rule	Executive age is ~30% behind chronological age. A 10-year-old child with ADHD has the executive self-regulation of a 7-year-old. Adjust supervision accordingly.
5. Make the Invisible Visible	Make physical rules visible. Clear boundaries, immediate feedback, and tangible tokens convert invisible intentions into concrete actions.
6. Praise Effort 3x More Than Correction	By age 12, a child with ADHD receives ~20,000 more negative messages than peers. Counteract this with specific, time-immediate praise for small wins.

Key Takeaway: ADHD is not a deficit in knowing what to do; it is a neurological deficit in doing what you know at the point of performance.